

JOSEPH MARKMAN

Qualitative Researcher · Digital Anthropologist · Cultural Analyst

Lyon, France · josephmarkman.com · hi@josephmarkman.com · English (Native) · French (C1)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Bilingual qualitative researcher (EN/FR) with an MA in Anthropology from Université Lumière Lyon II, specializing in digital ethnography and online community behavior. Two years of applied field experience in cross-cultural operations and intercultural mediation. Skilled at translating qualitative data and behavioral observations into clear, actionable insights for diverse stakeholders. Seeking to apply research expertise in a professional environment: market research, cultural intelligence, or tourism analytics.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Research & Analysis: Digital Ethnography · Netnography · Semi-structured Interviewing · Online Participant Observation · Qualitative Content Analysis · Thematic Synthesis

Applied & Strategic: Consumer & Cultural Insights · Online Community Research · Social & Digital Behavior Analysis · AI Ethics & Governance · Human-centered Service Design

Operations & Communication: Intercultural Mediation · Bilingual Field Coordination (EN/FR) · Stakeholder Liaison · B2B Client Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Intercultural Field Consultant · Freelance – River Cruise Tourism 2024 – Present

Clients: Feel of French Way, Un Monde Bleu, and 3 further agencies · 10+ cruise vessels, Lyon region

- Coordinate bilingual (EN/FR) logistics and passenger operations for 4 client agencies across 10+ river cruise vessels in the Lyon region, serving international traveler groups from North America, the UK, and Australia.
- Act as primary intercultural liaison between French-speaking operators and English-speaking guests, resolving cross-cultural communication issues in real time and adapting service delivery to diverse national expectations.
- Manage field operations independently with no direct oversight, maintaining quality across multiple concurrent agency relationships.

Strategic Co-Lead · Emerging Technology Apply Club, AAN (EASA) 2025 – Present

- Co-define research mandates to evaluate the social adoption patterns of emerging digital tools and platforms, as a part of the Applied Anthropology Network.
- Facilitate collaborative sessions that surface community insights and translate findings into applied recommendations.
- Apply anthropological frameworks to practical technology assessment within an interdisciplinary practitioner network.

Founder & Research Lead · Auxlia – Orientation & Support Concept 2025 – Present

auxlia.com

- Designed a proof-of-concept for a human-centered orientation service addressing cognitive friction in high-stress travel environments.
- Developed service frameworks grounded in mental-load reduction and accessibility principles, informed by qualitative research on traveler behavior.

Independent Researcher · Digital Anthropology & AI Ethics 2024 – Present

- Conduct ongoing research at the intersection of AI systems and social reality, focusing on ethical alignment and human-centered technology development.
- Synthesize qualitative observations and emerging literature into written analysis on digital culture, platform governance, and algorithmic influence on community behavior.

Real Estate Consultant · Keller Williams Village Square Realty 2019 – 2021

- Conducted comparative market analyses (CMAs) and guided clients through property transactions with a focus on negotiation strategy and transparent communication.
- Worked primarily with low-income, Section 8, and immigrant clients, bridging language and systemic barriers to help underserved communities navigate housing insecurity in northern New Jersey.

English Language Instructor · TAPIF Program, French Ministry of Education 2017 – 2019

- Delivered English language instruction in French public schools through the Teaching Assistant Program in France (TAPIF), one of the most competitive bilateral exchange programs between the US and France.
- Operated entirely within French-language institutional environments, developing professional fluency and cross-cultural adaptability from the outset of career.

EDUCATION

MA Anthropology (PRECIAM) · Université Lumière Lyon II 2021 – 2024

- Thesis: What do you meme? Digital Memes and Online Humor — An Anthropological Analysis of the Facebook Group 'Oui, Oui, Je Speak Franglais'
- Methods: Netnography, digital participant observation, semi-structured interviews, qualitative content analysis.
- Research focus: How internet memes shape collective identity and social cohesion in bilingual (FR/EN) online communities.

BA Anthropology & French · Rutgers University, New Brunswick 2013 – 2017

LANGUAGES

English — Native **French** — C1 Professional